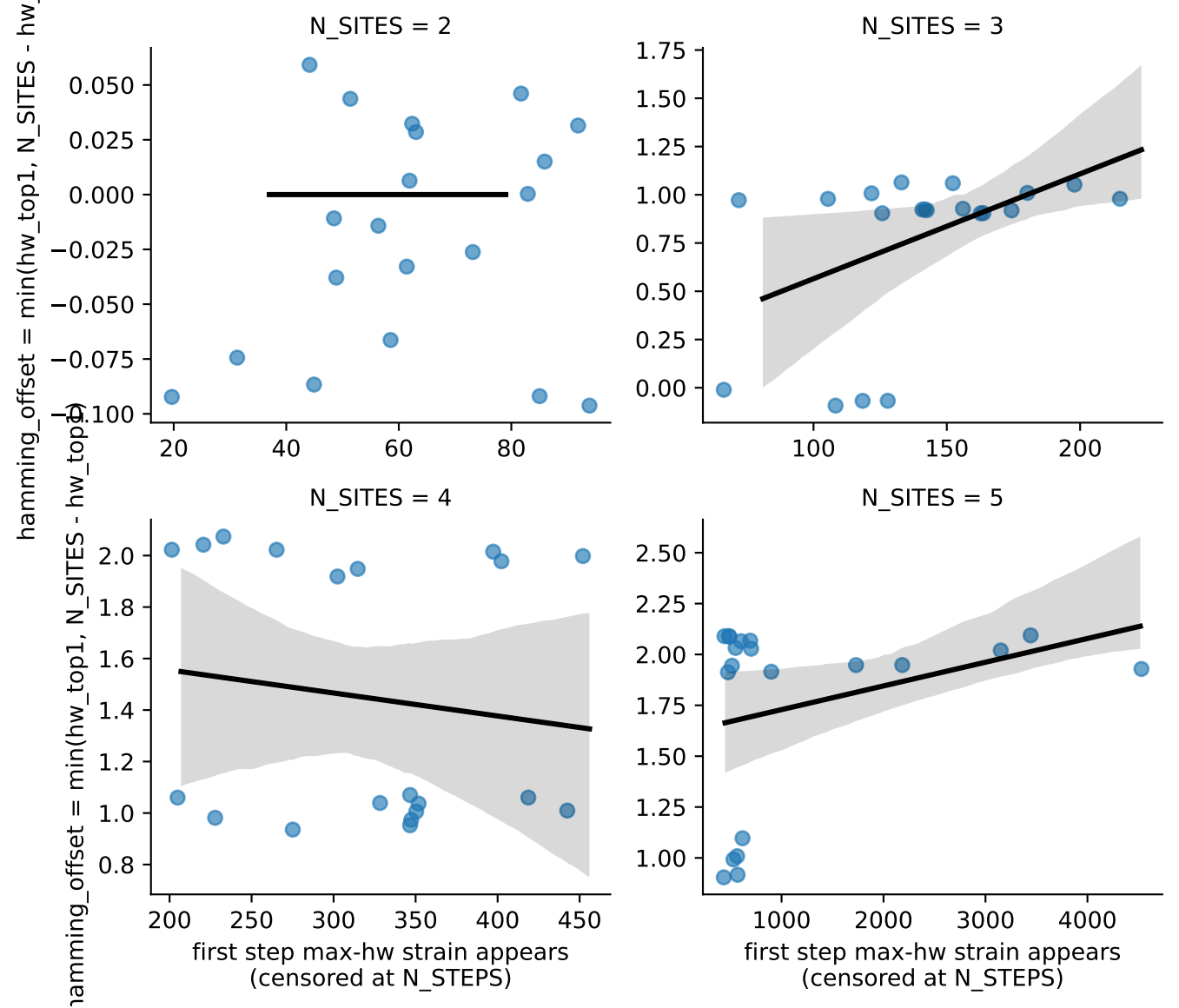
N_SITES = 2
N_SITES = 3
N_SITES = 4
N_SITES = 5
hamming_offset = min(hw_top1, N_SITES - hw_top0)
first step max-hw strain appears
(censored at N_STEPS)